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Organization and Classification Program Reference Guide

Key Concepts for OC Advisors

Pre-Evaluation Phase

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OCHRO

Office of the Chief Human Resources Officer

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Purpose

This reference guide is intended to build upon the information in earlier modules, support consistency in outcomes while allowing for flexibility in approaches in a departmental context, and to:

- familiarize the Organization and Classification (OC) Advisor with the main tools and information sources needed for the analysis leading to classification decisions.
- clarify the method and sequence of events to support classification decisions.
- share and explain best practices.

Later modules will demonstrate **how** each of these elements is used, analyzed, and justified, to arrive at a classification decision, in a variety of complexity levels, and the advice, options and recommendations provided to management.

Intended Audience

This reference guide is intended for:

- [organization and Classification \(OC\) Advisors](#) in training, as a preview of the core activities and principles of OC work;
- organization and classification advisors in training, as a companion to the practical, scenario-based elements; and
- accredited OC advisors, to provide additional clarity through interpretation of the expectations and requirements of the OC Program.

Chapter 1 Classification Decisions

The three types of classification activities are:

- [Classification decisions](#) are the result of evaluations by accredited and sub-delegated OC advisors, which establish or confirm the [occupational group \(OG\)](#), [subgroup](#) (if applicable), and level assigned to jobs, through the evaluation of [job descriptions \(JD\)](#). They can also be made by the deputy head, or in classification grievances, by a senior official designated by the deputy head.
- [Classification actions](#) are classification activities which do not impact a pre-existing classification decision as per the *Directive on Classification* (section 4.4):
 - Creating a position using a pre-existing [Standardized job descriptions \(SJD\)](#) within its evaluated organizational context;
 - Deleting a position without impacting the evaluations of surrounding positions; or
 - Changing the reporting relationship or title of a position without impacting its pre-existing evaluation or the evaluations of surrounding positions.
- [Administrative actions](#) are activities other than classification actions or classification decisions in which classification teams are responsible for HR system data entry (such as official languages, Security, Departmental ID).

A [Classification decision number](#) (or [job number](#)) is a number generated by the HR system assigned to a job evaluation. Each classification decision has an associated job number, regardless of how many positions are linked to that decision. All positions linked to the same job number **must** use the same title and JD.

1.1 Linking Positions to Classification Decisions

Classification decisions are rendered by evaluating the responsibilities of jobs in their specific organizational contexts and are applied by linking positions to a classification decision. When a classification decision has been rendered, it is formalized by recording it in the organization's HR system as well as in the Employer's central HR system. Each classification decision represents the evaluation of a single JD.

Once the classification decision has been established, its JD and associated evaluation can be applied or linked to positions.

1.2 Unique vs. Standardized Jobs

[Standardized job descriptions \(SJD\)](#) are applied to more than one position where all positions are classified at the same occupational group and level.

[Interdepartmental standardized job descriptions \(ISJD\)](#) are SJDs that apply across the [Core Public Administration \(CPA\)](#) that have been validated by the Office of the Chief Human Resources Officer (OCHRO) and given an alpha-numeric number.

[Unique Job descriptions](#) are applied to only one position.

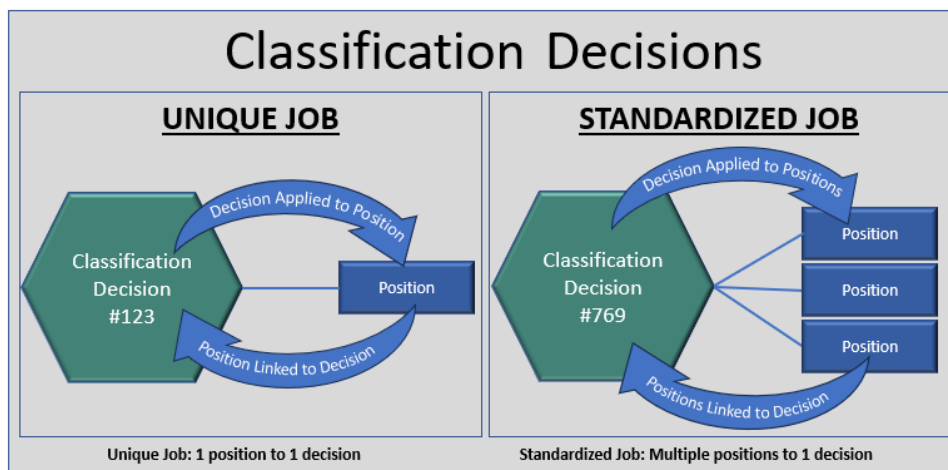


Figure 1. Classification Decisions: Unique and Standardized Jobs

EXPECTED APPROACHES:

Appropriate Use of SJDs:

Organizations are expected to ensure that standardized and unique JDs are used appropriately. This means that:

- **SJDs and ISJDs:** organizations and managers must implement ISJDs and SJDs wherever possible¹. As such, OC advisors are expected to work with managers to find and propose existing SJDs that meet their needs, whether new positions are being created, or existing positions are being updated because the work has evolved. If an existing SJD is not available, and the JD will apply to more than one position, a new SJD is developed, with associated [Application Criteria](#).
- **Unique JDs:** Reasonable effort should be made by OC advisors to limit the creation of unique JDs to the rare occurrences where only a single position is performing the functions across the CPA. Whenever a unique JD is considered, effort should be made to find existing pre-classified jobs, across the CPA.

Linking Positions to SJDs:

When linking positions to any JD, all [Key Activities](#) must apply, and all statements in the JD should support at least one Key Activity. Anything less than all of the Key Activities being assigned to a position is insufficient to justify the application of that JD to the position. The Key Activities of a JD should reflect the most important functions and deliverables of the position which comprise its core value added to the organization. If one or more Key Activities in a JD do not impact the evaluation of the job, it should be questioned whether they are in fact Key Activities.

Consolidating Classification Decisions:

OC advisors are expected to work with managers to consolidate identical jobs wherever possible, to reduce the redundancy of classification decisions (for instance when multiple very similar JDs have been used to describe identical jobs). This will also apply to the consolidation of classification decisions across the CPA when system capabilities are available to do so.

¹ Section 4.2.4 of the [Directive on Classification](#)

1.3 Classification decision outcomes.

- Creation of a new position(s).
- [Review and update of a position.](#)

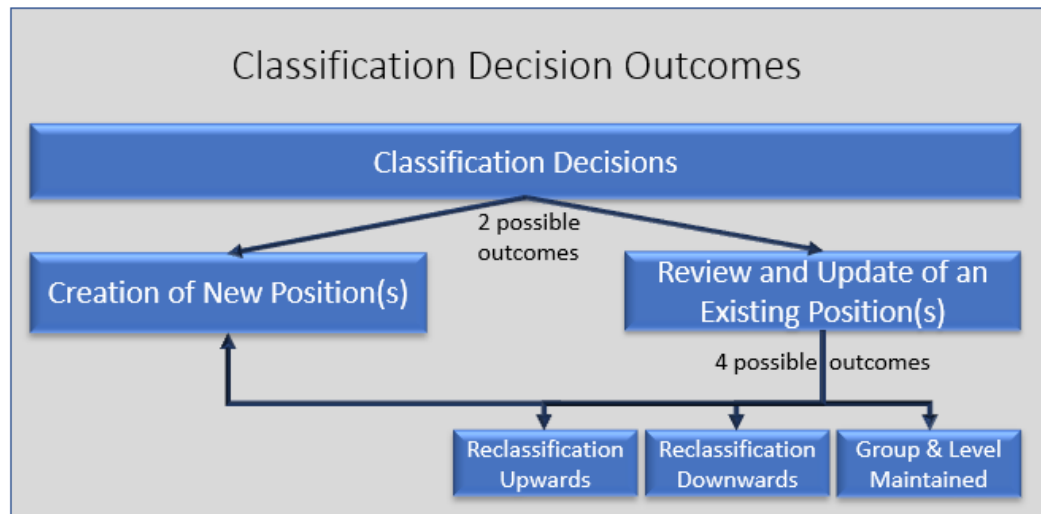


Figure 2. Outcomes of Classification Decisions

1.3.1 Creation of a position

Classification decisions are used to create positions in the following ways:

Applying an existing pre-classified SJD or applying a new decision when:

- the activities are new to the organization; or
- significant changes in the nature of the work have occurred over the course of time, outside of the natural evolution of the work continuum.

1.3.2 Review and Update

The JD applied to a position must be updated or replaced when:

- Significant changes in the work occur within the natural evolution of the work continuum; or
- New work is assigned or removed.

A review and update of a job has four possible outcomes:

- Group and level are maintained. This can occur in two ways:
 - with no changes to the previous evaluation ratings; or
 - with changes to the previous evaluation ratings.
- A new position is created: See 1.3.1 above.
- [Reclassification](#) upwards (when the outcome is an evaluation at a higher level as a result of changes to its assigned activities and/or organizational context); or
- Reclassification downwards (when the outcome is an evaluation at a lower level as a result of changes to its assigned activities and/or organizational context).

Examples of reasons that could justify a reclassification of a JD:

- Changes to the departmental or program mandate, or legislative framework.
- Reorganization by management:

- in response to external conditions that increase or decrease available resources.
- to make more efficient and effective use of their financial and human resources
- reassigning work among their employees to increase productivity, such as in response to changes in industry, or changes in governance, procedures, or processes.
- Natural evolution of work *within the same work continuum*. This means that over time, there is a progression in the scope of the work and the organizational context of positions linked to the same job. Promptly updating JDs when the duties evolve ensures:
 - that they remain complete and accurate statements of duties and responsibilities assigned; and
 - their associated incumbent entitlements (such as salary protection).
- Positions can also be reclassified as a result of a classification grievance.

EXPECTED APPROACH:

When SJDs are updated, resulting in a reclassification: if the changes apply to all the positions linked to the reassessed job, all positions linked to that classification decision are reclassified, and incumbents notified.

Table 1. Examples of natural evolution in work responsibilities in the same discipline or area of work

Examples of natural evolution in work responsibilities in the same discipline or area of work	
Previous Activities:	Evolved To:
conducting assigned research and analysis	organizing and planning program or project files
routine activities with established methods and procedures	non-routine activities requiring adaptation of methods and procedures.

Chapter 2 Effective Dates

An effective date is date on which a classification decision is established or is applied to a position. Managers are responsible for establishing effective dates that are reasonable and evidence based. The position file must include all relevant supporting job facts regarding the selection of the effective date.

2.1 Justifying an Effective Date

The following should be considered:

- When were the new duties assigned to the position?
- Were all the new duties assigned at once, or were they added over time?
- Which new duties made the difference to the evaluation level of the position, and when was that point reached?

2.2 Effective Dates of Classification Decisions

The [effective date of a classification decision](#) is the date on which the evaluation of the work described in a JD is implemented; the job may be applied to positions on or after this date.

2.2.1 Retroactive Effective Dates of Classification Decisions:

Retroactive classification decisions are those which have effective dates in the past; they are appropriate when managers have assigned the work, and employees have carried out those duties prior to the update of the JD.

Impacts of retroactive effective dates: Retroactive classification decisions are used to ensure that assigned duties are documented and evaluated accurately, ensuring employees are appropriately compensated for the work they perform, commensurate with the dates that the work is performed.

Subsequent Actions in the Past: The further back a retroactive effective date is in time, the more likely it is that other classification actions have taken place on the SP since the effective date. These must be analyzed to ensure that they are not impacted by the action being applied with an effective date before theirs. If they are impacted, further analysis is required to assess the impact of the sequence of events and the timeline make sense and are appropriate.

Approval of Retroactive Effective Dates of Classification Decisions: Retroactive effective dates usually require higher level approvals the further back in time they go, due to the costs and the impact of the retroactive reclassifications. The organization's Instrument of Sub-delegation of HR Authorities should be consulted for direction on the level of approval required depending on the retroactivity period.

While the OC advisor's role is to provide advice on the most appropriate effective date, managers have the delegated authority to decide the effective dates of the work that they assign.

2.2.2 Effective Dates of Upwards Reclassifications

The effective dates of upwards reclassifications should reflect the date on which the duties were assigned that make the difference in attaining the new group and level. Further additional duties could have been assigned after that date, but the employee(s) is entitled to the higher level pay as of the first day their duties warranted it. As such, many upwards reclassifications are retroactive.

Impacts

A retroactive effective date may have financial implications for the manager and the employee. The employee in the position at the time of the reclassification will be entitled to retroactive pay for the period during which they performed the assigned work.

2.2.3 Effective Dates of Downward Reclassifications

These are future dated, effective 30 days after the incumbent has been notified of the classification decision. This future date indicates the date on which salary protection is provided to the incumbent.

Note that a reclassification of a position does not automatically mean the reclassification of the incumbent. The staffing advisor's discussions with management will determine this. In addition, the financial impact should not be taken into consideration when determining effective dates.

2.2.4 Effective Dates of linking positions to Classification Decisions

Linking a position to a classification decision is the application of a classification decision (and its associated job number) to a position(s). The position may be a new position or an existing position that is being updated with the JD and classification decision in question. This date will show as the effective date of the classification decision being applied to the position.

Example Timeline 1: Data Entry vs Effective Date Timelines

Data Entry Date vs Position Timeline by Effective Date

- **2012:** A position was created in Jan 2012 using a *unique* JD.
- **2015:** The manager requests that the unique JD be used to create two additional positions. As the JD was unique, linking additional positions requires it be re-evaluated as an SJD, with a job evaluation committee.
- **2017:** The positions linked to this SJD now have access to higher security information. As such, the security levels of the positions were increased accordingly.
- **2021:** The positions' reporting relationships changed; they are now reporting to another manager in the same organization.
- **2023:** The positions were reviewed and updated with a different SJD, with a retroactive date to 2019. As the incumbents have been performing the work described in the 'new' SJD since April 2019, that is the appropriate effective date of the review and update.

NOTE: This review and update must be evaluated in its organizational context of 2019, before the change in reporting relationship. Then, the change in reporting relationship is re-assessed for impact of the 2019 activity.

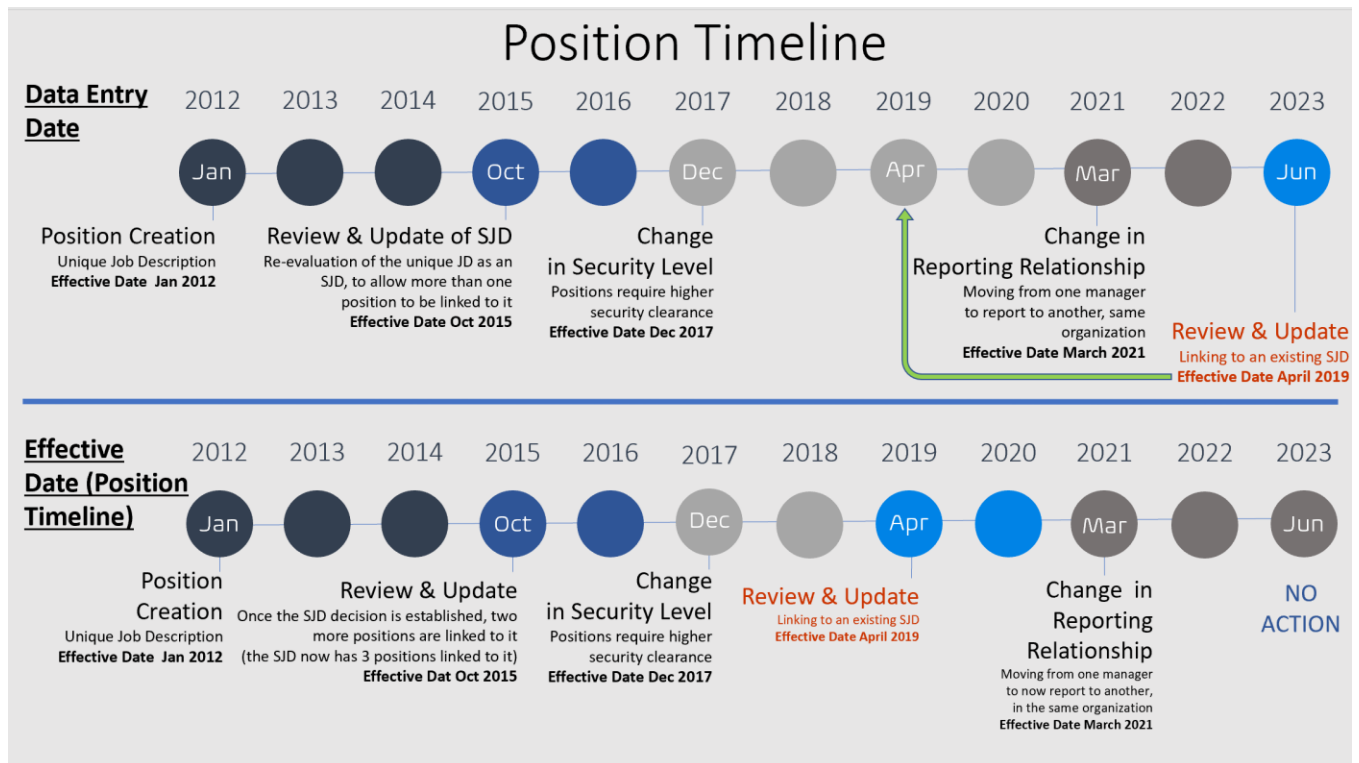


Figure 3. Example Position Timeline – Data Entry Date vs Position Timeline

Example Timeline 2: Linking Positions to Classification Decisions

Classification Decision Date vs Linking Positions to Classification Decisions

- **2014:** Evaluation of an SJD, followed by linking 5 existing positions to it (reviewed and updated with the new SJD).
- **2018:** Linking 1 more position to the SJD (the position is reviewed and updated with the SJD).

Potential Effective Dates:

- Effective date: 2013. The SJD cannot be applied to a position before it was established.
- Effective date: 2014. The SJD can be applied as soon as it is evaluated (that is, the SJD Decision Date).
- Effective date: 2018. The SJD can be applied on any date after the SJD decision date.
- Effective date: 2019. Actions with future effective dates should not be processed, exception downward reclassifications.

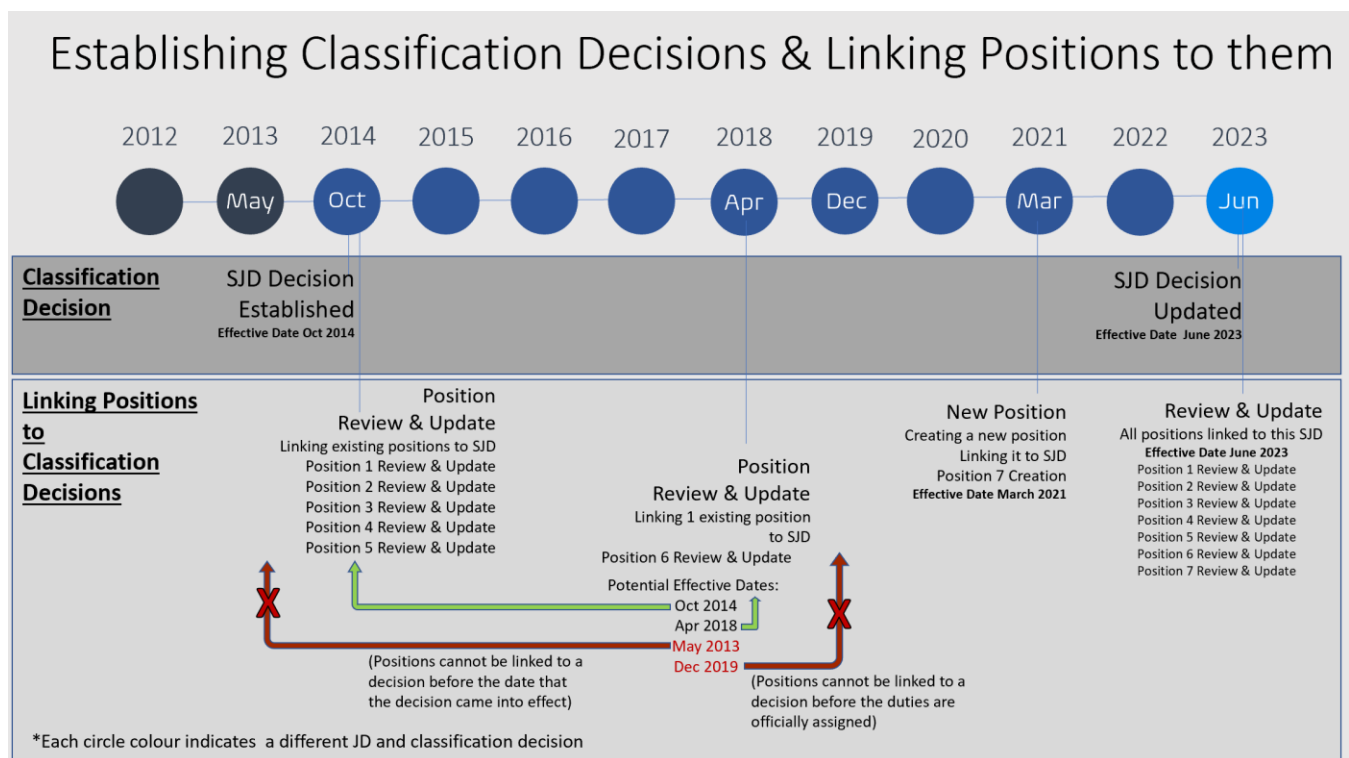


Figure 4. Example Timeline - Linking Positions to Classification Decisions

Chapter 3 Client Support, Standard of Care, and Relationship Management

3.1 Roles and Responsibilities

3.1.1 Role of the OC Advisor

The value OC advisors bring to the table is their specialized knowledge of the organization and classification of work. Clients (managers) are specialists in their own business lines. Both roles complement each other, and all efforts must be made to find ways to bring viable solutions to enable the client to deliver outcomes for Canadians in a timely, efficient, and cost-effective manner.

The deep expertise of the OC advisors is pivotal to the provision of holistic, timely and strategic advice, leveraging appropriate flexibilities within the classification framework.

Where appropriate, mutually agreed upon, priority-based plans should be established early on. These plans should include transparent benefits and risks to minimize surprises, and to support informed decision making by the client.

The OC advisor must frequently work with other HR specialists to determine whether the best solution is via an Organization and Classification approach, or another HR specialty, such as staffing, labour relations, etc. When developing options for clients, viable alternatives should be clearly defined, with risks and benefits clearly delineated.

NOTE: All of this can only happen in an environment of mutual respect and understanding.

3.1.2 Role of the Manager

Managers are responsible for:²

- Assigning work to their employees, as described in the selected JDs.
- Ensuring that their organizational charts reflect their business reality.
- Determining the [effective dates of the application of JDs](#).
- Implementing SJDs wherever possible.
- Providing relevant information and authorizations, as per organizational instruments of sub-delegation.
- Seeking advice from their OC advisor when:
 - proposing changes to their organizational structure.
 - needing or selecting a different JDs when the work changes.
- Ensuring that employees are notified each time a classification decision is rendered for the position they occupy.

3.2 Managing Client Expectations to Ensure the Delivery of Negotiated Priorities

Managing priorities and client expectations requires strong communication skills to build rapport and trust. To maintain good rapport, the client is regularly apprised of progress and plans are adjusted as new priorities arise. The following approaches can help with this:

- **Workload planning** includes distributing, scheduling, and monitoring work.
- **Priority management** involves the negotiation of work priorities and realistic timelines with the client to meet their most urgent operational needs within a plan that is both realistic and achievable, while not jeopardizing the Classification Program requirements.

² [Directive on Classification](#)

- **Project plans** outline priorities, deliverables, deadlines, and clarify requirements. They are particularly important when many jobs are evaluated simultaneously, such as in a restructure.

Accredited OC advisors have a dual role:

- To support managers in navigating the classification system, identifying, and applying flexibilities; and
- To maintain the relative value of work within that system.

The following behaviours are expected of OC advisors in managing client relationships and expectations:

- **Be realistic:** when estimating timelines and negotiating deadlines.
- **Be visible:** through regular updates to clients; project plans should be available to clients in real time (when required).
- **Make the process transparent:** share documents and tools openly, demystify and explain next steps.
- **Be true to your word:** consistently say what you will do and do what you said. Engage proactively when you cannot meet timelines and offer options.

3.3 Understanding Your Client's Business and Organizational Context

3.3.1 Why Context Is Important

Understanding the client's mandate and its context in the larger organization is essential to providing strategic advice and determining viable options that respond to their needs. Context is critical to determining the relative value of jobs.

OC advisors must develop a thorough understanding of their client's broader organizational context. Information on the organization, its mandate, services, and priorities can be found in the following places:

- Departmental/Agency intranet and internet sites.
- Departmental Plans³.
- Prime Minister's mandate letters to deputy heads (DHs)⁴.
- Management Accountability Framework⁵.
- Executive (EX) Group JDs (internal documents).
- Departmental / Agency Organizational Charts.
- Program documentation (organizational intranet/internet sites, or directly from the client).

3.3.2 How Much Information is Enough? How Much is Too Much?

Too much information can be just as damaging as not having enough. There is a fine balance between obtaining enough information to sufficiently inform and support the case, and obtaining so much superfluous information that it causes unnecessary delays.

Each case should be approached with the expectation of obtaining information from a variety of sources; the specific sources of information relevant to each case will differ according to the nature of the request.

³ [Departmental Plans](#)

⁴ [Mandate Letters | Prime Minister of Canada](#)

⁵ [Management Accountability Framework](#)

Chapter 4 Complementarity of Functions Within and Across Organizations

Every position has an effect, through its interactions with others in an organization.

Organizational design strives to optimize the effectiveness of the interactions of all parts of an organization. The first step of an OC advisor in evaluating jobs and creating positions is to explore the job and organizational context in which the positions will be created, and who their clients, stakeholders, partners, and colleagues will be (and how existing interrelationships between positions will be impacted by the new position(s)).

The inputs and outputs of every position are an indication of its interactions with the jobs around it in the organization, and its place in the workflow. The addition of a position to an organization (or its removal from an organization) inherently changes the nature of that organization and the manner in which it achieves success, due to its interactions with the positions around it; the same concept applies to removing positions from organizations.

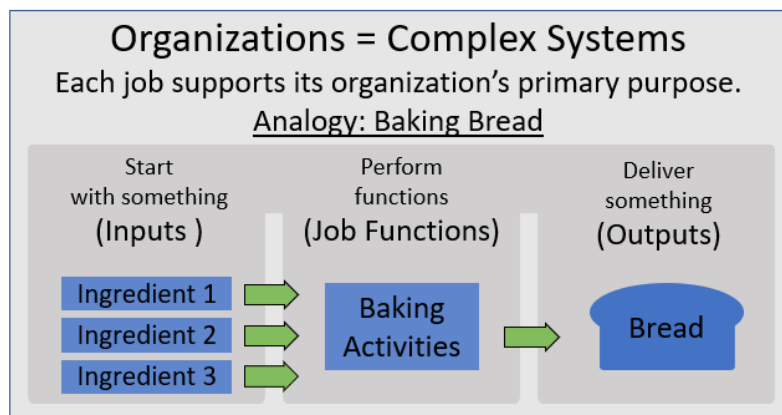


Figure 5. Organizations as Complex Systems

A functional analysis can help clarify how the roles in an organization work together to complement and support each other's common objective or deliverable. A detailed knowledge of the functions across an organization will help in the identification of overlapping functions between positions in an organization or across organizations. A functional analysis informs advice and guidance to decision makers, which may include structural and functional options provided.

This knowledge is obtained through client discussions, the study of the mandate, structure, technology, workflows, and the distribution of roles and responsibilities in the organization. The documents used for comparison may include, but may not be limited to:

- Organizational structure
- Service model
- JDs
- Job evaluation documentation

4.1 Complementary functions

Complementary functions are functions or mandates which, while different from one another, are aligned with, support, and enable each another to achieve a common goal or outcome.

Complementary functions are necessary for the success of an organization.

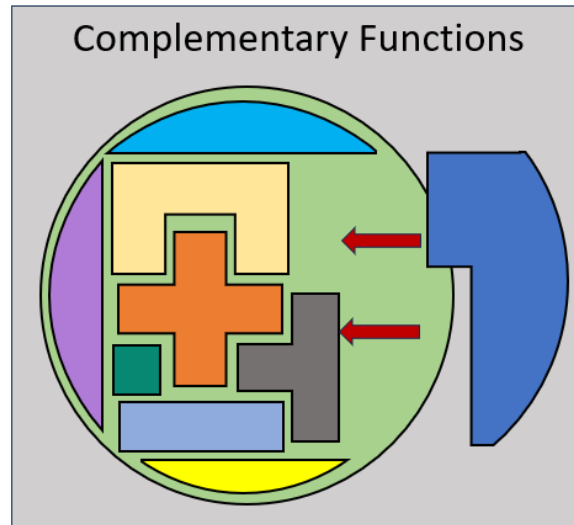


Figure 6. Complementary Functions

4.2 Overlap (of some or all functions)

Exploring the complementarity of functions in an organization includes ensuring no overlapping functions exist.

Overlap of functions occurs when:

- Two or more positions have the same function, producing **exactly** the same output OR:
- Positions or organizations with the same authority /role / responsibilities (**which do not allow for duplication**).

For example, using the bread analogy in Figure 5:
A bakery has two positions, both responsible for baking exactly the **same loaf** of bread for Customer A

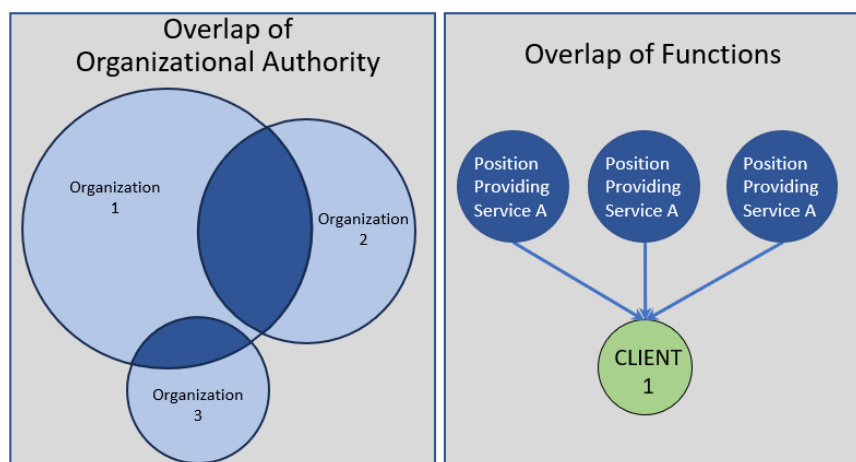


Figure 7. Overlap of Functions Example

Overlapping functions or roles should be avoided, and is an indication that roles, responsibilities, processes, and workflows are not sufficiently defined.

4.3 Duplication of Functions

[Duplication of functions](#) occurs when two or more positions have the same function, producing different outputs.

The duplication of functions is a common and effective solution to high workload or high volume of work and is not a cause for concern.

SJDs enable the duplication of functions. Compliance with the associated Application Criteria not only ensures the appropriate use of the SJD, but also ensures that the use of SJDs does not result in overlap.

For example, using the bread analogy in Figure 5:
A bakery has two positions, each responsible for baking loaves of bread for their respective clients, Customer A and Customer B.

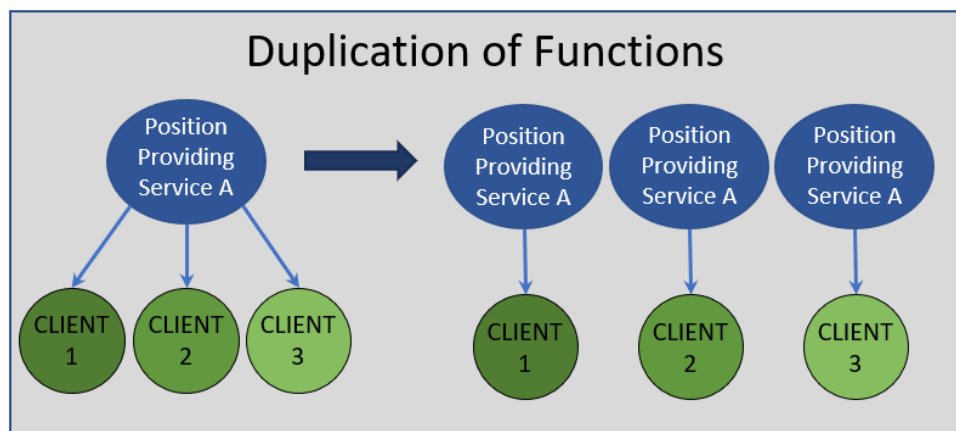


Figure 8. Duplication of Functions Example

Chapter 5 Classification Decision Process Overview

The classification decision process map below illustrates the high-level steps involved in rendering a classification decision.

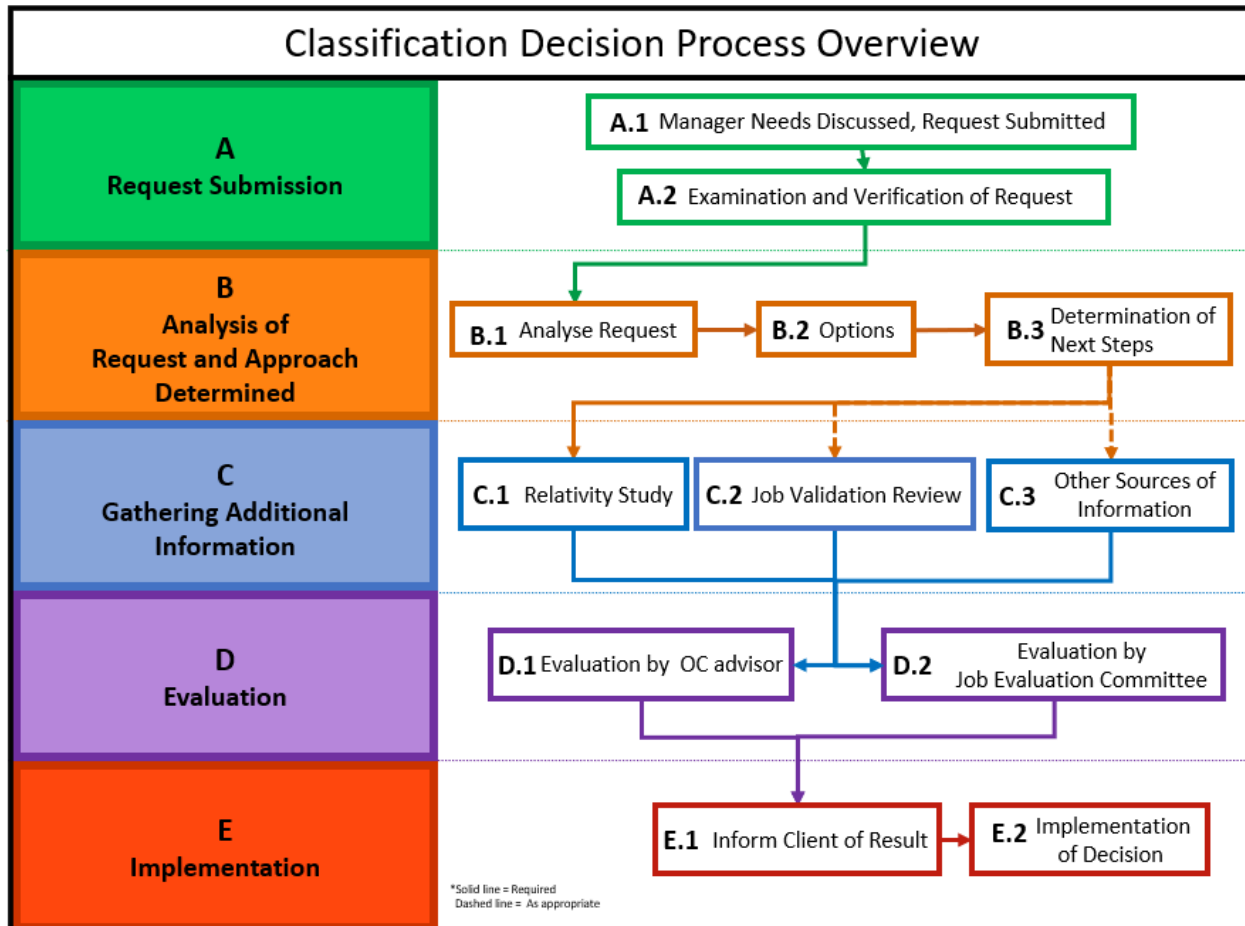


Figure 9. High Level Classification Decision Process Overview

This Reference Guide discusses the general pre-evaluation steps (A-C) in the Classification Decision Process and specific documents in those steps. Additional details regarding each individual step will follow in subsequent Reference Guides.

Chapter 6 Classification Requests – Preliminary Assessment

A Request Submission

A classification request presents an opportunity for the OC advisor to further engage the manager and to support them in meeting their changing business needs.

The request is a product of the manager's need to resolve an issue in meeting a business requirement, and the OC advisor's role is to find the organizational solution that will enable them to successfully deliver their mandate.

During the preliminary assessment of a classification request, the OC advisor should:

- **Determine the nature of the request**, and the most appropriate among the range of potential solutions that will best respond to the manager's short- and long-term needs. This also includes solutions that may best address the issues via different mechanisms such as staffing, labour relations, or others.
- **Provide advice and strategic options** upfront.
- **Examine the submitted documentation** for completeness and appropriateness, verifying that they are authorized (that is, signed and dated) in accordance with the departmental instrument of sub-delegation of human resources (HR) authorities. As a best practice, the documentation is finalized before the request is assessed.

Table 2. Request Authorization Responsibilities of managers

Request Authorization Responsibilities	
Managers are responsible for:	Relevant documents and references
Initiating classification requests via departmental processes	Departmental instruments for the sub-delegation of HR authorities
Selecting and authorize the job description (JD) s that reflect the work assigned	Selected JDs
Determining the work distribution and structure, (outlined in signed organizational charts)	Organizational charts
Determining the effective dates of the work assigned and specified in approved JDs	JDs and Organizational charts

Next steps are determined by the nature of the manager's business needs and will differ depending on the situation. Answers to the following questions should be considered:

- Are the organization and program well established?
- Is the manager implementing a new program and/or structure?
- Is the manager contemplating organizational design options for a future state?

Chapter 7 Organizational Charts

B

Analysis of Request and Approach Determined

Organizational charts are among the documents required when rendering classification decisions and are an important source of information that allows a deeper analysis of the submitted request.

Organizational charts are graphical depictions of the hierarchical arrangement of work and lines of authority in place to support the achievement of business objectives. It is the responsibility of the manager to ensure that their organizational chart is kept up to date and reflective of their current business reality.

The primary purpose of organizational charts in classification is to depict the structural relationship of the [subject position\(s\) \(SP\)](#) to other positions in the same unit or division (above, below, and adjacent to it). The organizational chart associated with a classification analysis must reflect the current business realities as of the effective date of the action. While in most cases this is the current organizational structure, it could be retroactive, in which case the organizational chart must reflect the business reality as of that retroactive date.

7.1 Requirements

7.1.1 Organizational charts must⁶:

- Be signed and dated by the authorized manager, as per the departmental Instrument of sub-delegation of HR authorities.

7.1.2 As a best practice, organizational charts should:

- Depict the position and its relationship to the other positions in the same unit or division that is in effect for the period covered by the activity, clearly and legibly.
- Include the manager's name, signature, date of signature, position title, and effective date of the activity.
- Show positions above, below, and adjacent to the SP in the organization, including the authorizing manager's position, **as of the effective date of the classification activity resulting from the request.**
- Reflect the current organizational structure with the changes requested or when major changes are needed, separately reflect the end state.

Table 3. Position, JD and incumbent Information to include on organizational charts.

Information to include on organizational charts	
JD Information (to include)	Personal Information (not to include)
Position Title	
Position Number	Employee Personal Record Identifier (PRI)
Position Classification Group/ Level or 'proposed' if new	Employee Salary
Position Security Requirement	Employee Security Clearance
Position Language Requirements and Linguistic Profile	Employee Second Language Evaluation Results
Status of the position (i.e., term, indeterminate)	Employee Employment Status
If occupied: Incumbent name*/ If vacant: Vacant	

⁶ Section B.2.2.9 of the [Directive on Classification](#)

*Each indeterminate employee must have their own position, positions with more than one indeterminate employee must be addressed.	
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Chapter 8 Job Descriptions

B

Analysis of Request and Approach Determined

Job descriptions are among the documents required when rendering classification decisions and are a source of critical information that allows a deeper analysis of the submitted request.

Job descriptions are comprised of statements that describe the assigned functions and work activities which are relevant to the evaluation of the work, in language that is as broadly applicable as possible while still describing the functions accurately.

8.1 Requirements

8.1.1 JDs must^{7,8}:

- Use inclusive, gender-neutral, plain language and contain all significant aspects of the assigned work required to evaluate the job. Gender-neutral language avoids the use of gender-specific pronouns, [job titles](#), and other terms that may suggest a preference for one gender over another.
- Concisely demonstrate the primary purpose of the job and reflect the four factors (skill, effort, responsibility and working conditions) as set out in the *Pay Equity Act*⁹ and its associated Regulations¹⁰.

8.1.2 As a best practice, JDs should:

- Include:
 - The organizational context, mandate, and supervisor–subordinate relationships.
 - An inclusive title that reflects the functions and nature of the work described.
- Avoid:
 - Restrictive information such as department name or sector name. to allow a broader use of the JD both within and between organizations.
 - Specific terminology that rapidly ages a job (specific technology, program, working group, etc.).
 - Redundant information, jargon or vague terms open to multiple interpretations.
 - Over- or understating the complexities of the work.
 - Linking JDs to performance objectives, service standards or qualification standards.

⁷ [Directive on Classification](#)

⁸ [Job Description Writing Guide](#)

⁹ [Pay Equity Act \(justice.gc.ca\)](#)

¹⁰ [Pay Equity Regulations \(justice.gc.ca\)](#)

Every JD must contain the following identifying information:

Table 4. Identification information required on all JDs.

JD Identification information		
Job Number / Classification Decision Information		
Job Title (English)	Job Title (French)	
Job number	Authorized group and level	Decision Effective Date
Position Identifying Information: specific position information - completed each time a JD is applied		
Position Number	Position Effective Date	
Department / Agency	Sector / Directorate / Region / Division	National Occupational Classification (NOC) code
Security Requirements	Geographic Location	Office Code
Supervisor Position Number	Supervisor Position Title	Supervisor Group & Level
Communication Requirements	Linguistic Requirements	Linguistic Profile

8.2 Job Description Content

8.2.1 Organizational context:

The context in which the work is performed, its location in the hierarchy, its authority and span of control.

8.2.2 Client Service Results (CSR):

The primary purpose of the job describing the products and services it provides or delivers, and to whom.

8.2.3 Key Activities (KA):

These are the most important responsibilities of the position that must be performed to produce the expected outcomes of the Client Service Results. All statements in the JD should support at least one Key Activity. They should be written in a clear, precise, and concise manner.

8.2.4 Work Characteristics

Skill

- The intellectual and physical skill, including the knowledge required to deliver on the responsibilities and achieve the primary purpose of the job.
- The intellectual and physical aptitudes acquired through experience, training, education, or natural ability.

Effort

Sensory and physical effort, in terms of any exertion required by the job, the intensity and duration of the effort.

- **Physical effort:** physical exertion required including physical movements and working positions (for example standing, reaching, or climbing).
- **Sensory effort:** activities and effort related to the use of any of the five senses (taste, hearing, sight, smell, touch).

Responsibility

The responsibility for human, financial, and technical resources, including work tools, accountabilities, and delegations.

- **Human Resources:** the responsibility for supervision: supervising subordinates, leading working groups, requirements to supervise contractors or students, and supervisory responsibilities in a project environment.
- **Financial Resources:** the responsibility for the stewardship and control of financial resources in planning, controlling, acquiring and spending funds.
- **Technical Resources:** the responsibility for the custody, use, production, maintenance, repair and protection of physical assets used and products created.

Working Conditions

The normal conditions under which the work is performed. These conditions relate to the physical environment and the psychological climate, including noise, temperature, isolation, physical hazards, health risks and stress.

NOTE: JDs should not describe duties to be performed in the future, unless the effective date is for the future and the expectation is that the new duties will be required on a future date. See Effective Dates chapter for more information.

8.2.5 Analyzing and Providing Advice on JD Content

Prior to evaluating JDs, OC advisors must ensure that they *can* be evaluated, addressing missing information, unclear language and other necessary amendments, clarifying language, including how terms are interpreted. Those changes that impact the job evaluation must be incorporated into the JD before the formal evaluation of the job.

As an example, 'attending meetings' should state the job's role and authority at the meetings, and with whom it interacts. Information on how to interpret specific terms and in what way should be clear when evaluating the job.

Poorly described work can lead to erroneous decisions. OC advisors should ensure that issues are addressed to ensure a clear understanding of the job. JD amendments or the selection of a different JD may be appropriate when there is non-[coincidence](#) between the work assigned by managers and that conducted by employees.

Analysis may reveal the following concerns:

- **Key information is missing** Details which would impact the evaluation of the job must be included to enable the job to be evaluated with the appropriate [job evaluation standard \(JES\)](#).
- **Job information inconsistent** with its organizational structure or mandate.
- **Information that is too detailed**, which can obscure the purpose of the work.
- **Superfluous information** is included, for example duties not being carried out by the incumbent.

8.2.6 Content of SJDs

The responsibilities described in SJDs must be concise and complete, and include all information required for its evaluation with the appropriate JES. SJDs should describe the job in a manner that is both, **y enough** to apply to as many positions as possible and **detailed enough** for the OC advisor to evaluate using the appropriate JES.

EXPECTED APPROACH:

In the context of the ever-increasing use of SJD across the CPA, a shift in approach to HR developing the JDs and managers selecting best fit JDs is essential. This means that instead of changing the content of an SJD, efforts are made to find an SJD that more accurately reflects the responsibilities of the job, wherever possible. If an existing SJD is not available, a new SJD is developed, with associated Application Criteria, and positions linked to it as appropriate. When changes to SJDs are made, if the changes apply to all linked positions, ALL positions must be updated, and incumbents notified; language should be used that is as standardized as possible. OC advisors are

expected to support managers towards this goal. The new or modified SJD must be evaluated with a [job evaluation committee](#).¹¹

For SJDs, if the changes apply to all the positions linked to the reassessed job, all positions linked to that classification decision are reclassified.

8.3 Application Criteria, Organizational Context and SJD Evaluation

What they are: Application Criteria summarize the contextual information outlining the organizational context(s) in which each SJD has been evaluated and can be applied as-is, without additional analysis by an accredited OC advisor.

How to establish Application Criteria: The organizational context of the work is considered in every job evaluation. It is possible however that an SJD may also be valid and applicable in more than one organizational context. Therefore, the SJD evaluation process must include an exploration and consideration of additional organizational contexts in which it is likely to be applied; those organizational contexts in which it can be applied without impacting the decision must be recorded in the Application Criteria associated with each SJD.

Application Criteria:

- enable classification actions to be used and approved by [persons trained in OC](#) **without** consulting accredited OC advisors.
- clarify the boundaries of the decision, to enable the OC Program to be delivered more efficiently through the clarification of the contexts in which any Classification Decision may be appropriately applied by Persons Trained are evolving documents that and should be continuously reassessed and updated as the SJD is applied in an ever-growing number of organizational contexts.
- support managers to easily determine whether an SJD can be applied in their organizational context without further analysis by an OC advisor.

EXPECTED APPROACH:

Application Criteria are a powerful tool to enable the wide use of SJDs by clearly delineating classification decisions once rendered. They allow decisions to be leveraged by non-accredited, trained individuals, without drawing on the operational capacity of accredited OC advisors. They also show managers whether an SJD can be applied in their organizations without further analysis. They are not intended to limit managers' use of an SJD in other organizational contexts; If a manager wishes to apply an SJD in an organizational context outside those included in that SJD's Application Criteria, an accredited OC advisor must analyze whether the existing classification decision continues to apply. If so, the SJD is applied in that context and its Application Criteria are expanded to include the new context by the OC advisor; if not, the SJD must be evaluated in that context and a new classification decision rendered by an accredited OC advisor, or another SJD is selected which accurately describes the work, and whose Application Criteria include the proposed organizational context.

8.4 Functional Authorities

Many organizations have established functional authorities for certain areas (such as information technology, finance, communications, human resources); and their control over their function can vary, per Deputy Head organizational decisions.

These functional authorities may have full or limited accountability for their function; their authority may be limited to their own organization, or apply enterprise-wide, for example the performance of Translator work

¹¹ [Directive on Classification](#)

(TR) is limited to a specific organization. Some functional authorities are accountable for the function outside their own subordinate structure, and have established approval mechanisms, while some have opted to centralize all related work and positions within their structures (such as communications). OC advisors are expected to be familiar with the functional authorities established for their organization.

NOTE: While the scope of [functional authority](#) responsibilities varies across organizations, usually linked to *where* in the organization functions may be performed, functional authority does not include determination of appropriate occupational group, which is the purview of [accredited](#) OC advisors.

Chapter 9 Relativity Study

C

Gathering Additional Information

Classification relativity refers to similar jobs in various organizational contexts and organizations. [Classification Relativity Studies](#) are one of the ways gather additional information in preparation to evaluate jobs.

They are analyses which compare the responsibilities and organizational context of the SP with those of other jobs. The jobs or positions that are compared to the SP are referred to as [relative positions](#) (RPs). Relativity studies result in relativity reports, which are snapshots of job responsibilities across organizations; they should include an indication of not only the different types of organizational contexts, their evaluations (and any additional pertinent information that informed them) of the positions being compared, but also the relative proportions of those results. The relativity may include jobs with responsibilities that differ from those of the SP, but that are nonetheless relevant as comparators in its evaluation. Documents examined in relativity comparisons include JDs, organizational charts, and Job Evaluation Rationales.

9.1 Purpose of Relativity Studies

The relativity study informs the classification decision process by presenting a snapshot of evaluated jobs at a specific point in time across the organization or the CPA.

9.2 Requirements

9.2.1 Relativity analyses must:

- be conducted whenever a job evaluation occurs. All classification decisions must be informed by relativity. At a minimum, a relativity analysis and summary must be placed on the SP file¹².

9.2.2 Information that should be included in relativity studies includes:

- **Key facts** explaining the impacts of the responsibilities or organizational contexts of the RPs on their evaluations (which can be similar or different from those of the SP).
- **Relative proportions** of classification outcomes found in the relativity.
 - As an example, if the evaluation of the SP is in line with a small minority of similar jobs found in the relativity search across the CPA, the aspects of the work of that small minority which sets them apart from the remaining jobs are explained.
 - Evaluations of any RPs which are not supportable, and why.
- **Analysis** of the compiled relativity information, and the determination of what information is included in the analysis are the purview of OC advisors. Analyses are conducted before the formal evaluation of the SP takes place.
- **Explanation of inconsistencies**, where possible, to address manager concerns regarding specific relativities.

¹² Section B.2.2.9 of the [Directive on Classification](#)

9.3 The Relativity Study Process

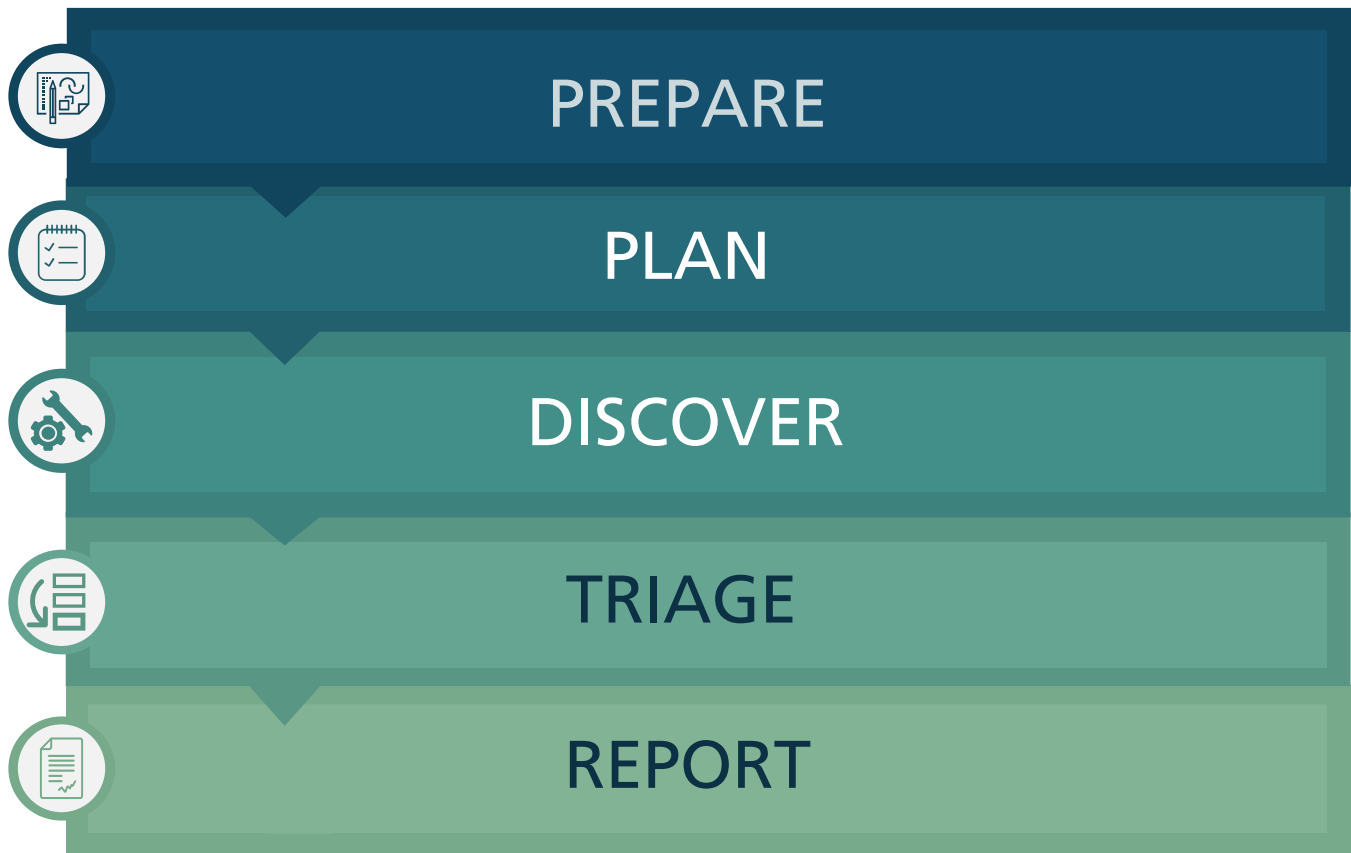


Figure 10. The steps in the Relativity Study process.

9.3.1 Prepare

Ensure that the details of the case are well understood before undertaking a relativity study; these will determine the objectives and purpose of the study, which stem from the nature of, and reasons behind, the [classification activity](#). Recognizing the type of information that would fully inform the decision is of central importance.

9.3.2 Plan

Preliminary Identification of Classification Relativity Sources

EXPECTED APPROACH:

Per the *Directive on Classification* (section 4.1.8.2), and in support of decision transparency and Program delivery efficiency, it is essential that all job records (at minimum JD, Evaluation Rationale and Organizational Chart) must be uploaded to the Employer Central HR system and maintained. This means all jobs **must** be accessible and visible, even those identified as [not to be used for relativity](#).

Scope of the relativity search:

- Relativity searches should always be conducted across the CPA, and include:
 - Similar responsibilities in different contexts to those of the SP.

- Similar responsibilities that are only found in other organizations.
- When the same responsibilities are not found anywhere in the CPA, effort should be made to find other positions that, while not performing the same job, have comparable levels of responsibility.
- When the manager indicates that other organizations have classified similar jobs differently than the home department, these jobs should be included.

Consider the following approaches in the preliminary identification of relativities:

- Explore organizations that have programs or mandates that are similar, intersect or [overlap](#) with that of the SP.
- Explore jobs and organizational contexts that are both similar and different from the SP, in terms of scope and latitude.
- A search by job title is a start.
- Keep an open mind regarding the diversity of the occupational groups that are considered. Explore occupational groups that may not be immediately obvious to inform the comparison with the SP: Some occupational groups are limited to specific organizations but may be similar to the SP in aspects that can be very informative.

Similar positions that are found in separate departments/agencies may be classified in different occupational groups for reasons specific to their organizations' mandates. Emphasis should be placed on the **type** of information gathered rather than the volume. Specifically, the different contexts and responsibilities of the relative jobs should serve to inform the job evaluation by providing a snapshot of existing relevant classification evaluations.

9.3.3 Discover

Where to start:

- The main search tool is the Position and Classification Information System Plus ([PCIS+](#)). It is a Treasury Board Secretariat (TBS) developed document repository, containing position information as submitted by departments and agencies to the Treasury Board Secretariat. It can be used to extract useful information on potential job comparators, such as reporting relationships, action types, and evaluations dates.
- Additional avenues of inquiry which could lead to identifying relativity information could include:
 - Public Service Commission staffing notices, which can lead to information on recently reviewed jobs;
 - OC or Staffing colleagues across the CPA (particularly in similarly sized organizations or those that have similar mandates/jobs); and/or
 - Position files.

9.3.4 Triage

Determining which Relative Positions to Include in the Analysis:

The OC advisor determines which relativities have the most probative value to the evaluation of the SP.

NOTE: There is no 'good' or 'bad' relativity, only those that are relevant (or not) to the current case. *If it is pertinent to the classification decision, then it should be included.*

Problematic Relativity Evaluations:

If a RP job is pertinent to the evaluation of the SP, but its evaluation cannot easily be defended, the RP may nonetheless remain relevant to the evaluation in its comparison to the SP job responsibilities and context. The problematic evaluation of the RP can also be used to explain how the ratings do not align with other RPs, that the evaluation is not fully aligned with the classification JESs and should not inform the SP evaluation. This can be particularly helpful when RPs with problematic evaluations or missing information are brought to the OC advisor's attention by managers. The relativity analysis must also identify positions that are considered as anomalies in the SP's organization. Problematic evaluations must not be replicated; managers are to be provided with alternative options to address their needs.

EXPECTED APPROACHES:

Inaccurately classified jobs:

Those found within the SP's organization should be corrected.

When problematic evaluations are found in other organizations, those organizations must be informed of the discrepancy/unfounded rating to allow for corrective measures via a pre-established communications approach between heads of classification.

Organizational Contexts are Different:

Organizational context can significantly impact evaluations. The impact of organizational context can be explained in relativities where similar responsibilities are found in varied organizational contexts, to inform the evaluation of the job, the manager, and the organizational options provided.

When Evaluations Differ Between Organizations:

The relativity documentation should provide adequate justification for the evaluation within the context of the RP, which can then be compared and contrasted to the SP's ratings in its context.

Age of the classification decision:

The integrity or usefulness of a classification decision does not necessarily degrade over time. All jobs must be shared, regardless of the age of the decision.

The positions are currently under review:

All JDs should periodically be reviewed, and re-evaluated if anything has changed. The fact that a job is under review does not diminish the integrity and usefulness of the current JD and evaluation; they must be shared.

The classification decision is the subject of a [classification grievance](#):

The grieved classification decision and JD on file are considered valid and can be used as relativity until the grievance decision is rendered. At that time, the OC advisor along with management must review all identical positions to determine if that new classification grievance decision should be used to review these positions.

Group allocation cases:

When group allocation is unclear, include RPs of each group being considered.

Positions Not to Be Used for Relativity:

Jobs or positions may be marked as 'not to be used for relativity' for many reasons. This designation is used for decisions known to lie outside the classification framework and information explaining the reason should be on file. They should also contain an action plan and timelines to redress the situation. Regardless, job records must be uploaded to the Employer HR system and shared upon request.

Considerations:

- Not all relativity information that *could* be included *needs* to be included. Only the most salient examples should be included to ensure that the overall picture of relativity is clearly explained.
- Relativity neither confirms nor validates job evaluation decisions; rather, it contributes to informing classification decisions.

9.3.5 Report

The results of relativity studies are presented in **relativity reports** (more information may be found in [Relativity Analysis Report Template](#)), which include **four parts**:

9.3.5.1 Purpose:

In this section of the relativity analysis report, the background and the purpose of the study would need to be explained.

9.3.5.2 Methodology/Considerations

The methods and tools used to identify the relativity needs to be described and explained, as well as any challenges encountered while conducting the relativity research. If applicable, an explanation regarding the limited internal and/or external relativity would need to be provided. In this section, the elements considered to choose the comparators need to be described.

9.3.5.3 Analysis:

A detailed analysis of RPs pertinent to the classification decision being made. When only a specific aspect of the RP is pertinent, the analysis can highlight this aspect.

9.3.5.4 Narrative Summary:

A concise summary of the analytical results of the relativity study, which contains only the information essential to the evaluation of the SP, presenting relevant details to inform the evaluation. The summary should clearly show how the responsibilities and/or contexts of the RPs are similar to or differ from those of the SP, and include detailed comparisons that are key to informing the evaluation of the SP. The narrative summary will serve as the basis or inspiration for writing the relativity section of the job evaluation rationale or committee report.

Chapter 10 Job Validation Review (JVR)

C

Gathering Additional Information

[Job Validation Reviews \(JVR\)](#) are one of the ways to gather additional information in preparation to evaluate jobs. They are analyses that involve fact finding activities conducted with employees to obtain a better understanding of jobs, to better inform their evaluation. They are also conducted to determine the degree of coincidence between the work as described in a JD, and as performed by the incumbent(s).

10.1 Purpose of JVRs

The overarching purpose of JVRs is the gathering of details regarding the duties of the job to supplement or clarify those in the JD, enabling a fully informed evaluation of the job. Informed, evidence-based evaluations make it possible to optimally leverage the flexibilities within the classification framework. How the information is collected matters less than understanding, recognizing, and achieving this goal. The purpose of JVRs is more than to simply satisfy policy requirements; they can be useful for the following reasons:

- **Evolution of Duties:** Document **if, when and how** the overall work has evolved. This information is used to inform the most appropriate effective date of the classification decision.
- **Reclassification:** Inform the decision where a reclassification is likely or proposed.
- **Missing or superfluous information:** Identify missing information from the JD, which may need to be included before evaluating the job, for example to ensure that the organizational context of the job is clear. Conversely, any information that is included but not performed should be removed from the JD.
- **Primary purpose of the job:** Clarify information to enable clear allocation to an occupational group.
- **Coincidence between the work assigned and the work performed:** Confirming the duties of the selected JD are fully assigned and the JD is well applied. Alternatively, supporting the selection of a different JD.
- **Overlap and complementarity of functions:** Illustrating how the role of the job differs from, is similar to, overlaps with or complements other positions, clarifying ambiguity in the division of responsibilities.
- **Interpretation of JD language:** Clarifying specific aspects or complexities of the work, allowing a clear determination of evaluation ratings.
- **Facilitate Employer/employee communication:** As an opportunity to explain classification to employees, acknowledge and consider all aspects of their work for the evaluation and ensure they are compensated appropriately.
- **Complex cases involving other HR specialties:** Where outcomes are anticipated to require additional explanation and evidentiary support (i.e., precedent setting, DH directed classification decisions sought, anticipated classification grievance, or labour relations situations).
- **Classification Grievances:** To provide additional information for re-examination process.
- **Monitoring/Audit:** To provide additional information for use in a monitoring exercise or audit.

10.2 Requirements

A JVR is required when a proposed or possible reclassification may occur, or when a better understanding of the job is needed¹³.

¹³ Section 2.2.3 of the [Directive on Classification](#)

10.3 Participants in the JVR process

- JVRs are conducted by OC advisors with the current incumbent(s) of the position(s), employee(s) currently performing the work under review, or with those that performed it recently and have an extensive knowledge of the work. The JD approved by the manager outlines the assigned work, and the JVR explores and relates what the JD means in the context under study, through work examples. The manager's approval is obtained before employees are contacted.
- Employees and managers are provided the opportunity to provide feedback on the contents of the JVR Report before it is finalized.

10.3.1 Who can be present at a JVR?

Bargaining agent representative: the employee may request the presence of their bargaining agent representative to accompany them, as an observer, during the JVR.

Supervisor/Manager of the SP: the SP's supervisor should not be present at a JVR. They confirmed the duties assigned by selecting and approving the JD.

Other employees (whose positions share the same JD as the SP): Usually the JVR discussion is limited to the Reviewer and the employee. In some circumstances, several JVRs or a JVR with several employees may be appropriate. Similarities and differences can be highlighted more easily with employees from the different organization in the same conversation.

10.3.2 Determining which employees will be included in the JVR process.

Sample sizes: When JVRs are being conducted on positions using SJDs, sample size will be determined by the approach to conduct JVRs with only as many employees as necessary. Appropriate sampling protocols should be followed which ensure that the information gathered is representative of the full range of organizational types and contexts, programs, environments that use the JD under review. This is of particular relevance when JVRs are being conducted on positions using large, broadly applied SJDs.

10.4 The Job Validation Review Process



Figure 11. The steps in the JVR process.

10.4.1 Prepare

Review the job information. JDs of the employee and supervisor, organization chart, prior evaluations, mandate of the organization, etc. to understand the organizational and business context of the job.

- **Preliminary evaluation of the SP.** Consult the [Table of Concordance](#) to identify the JES(s) most likely to apply. If the primary purpose of the job is not clear, identify missing information as well as language that is unclear or open to interpretation. Address missing and unclear information with the manager before the employee is contacted.

- **Formulate the initial questions to the employee.** The steps presented in Figure 11 will expose which topics should be pursued in the review and support the development of the initial questions asked of the employee to thoroughly understand the job. If needed, follow up questions may be appropriate.
- **Determine JVR approach.** The JVR approach should always be case-specific; the information validation can take place in a variety of ways, depending on the identified needs (see Figure 8.2):
 - **A discussion with the employee**, whether face-to-face, via telephone or videoconference.
 - **A questionnaire** containing questions specific to the case.
 - **A combination** of a discussion and a questionnaire.

Consideration: Tour the workplace whenever possible, when relevant, to gain important perspective and context and to recognize aspects of the work relevant to is evaluation that the employee may not have identified. This can be particularly helpful when considering jobs which are manual in nature, consisting of the handling or manipulation of objects.

- **Obtain authorization to contact employee.** Before proceeding, inform the employee's supervisor that a JVR is required, obtaining authorization to contact them, and ensure accommodation needs are met.

Job Validation Review Methodologies			
	Circumstances	Benefits	Drawbacks
Discussion with Employee	Where: Much information is needed Clarity is needed Interpretation of language needed When testing the limits of flexibility of the classification framework, allows deep-dive into lines of questioning.	Most efficient use of time Minimal impact to operational capacity Minimal delays in rendering a decision One meeting in which all lines of inquiry are pursued	Employee availability for interviews
Questionnaire	When it is not possible to speak to the employee directly. When the information sought is more straightforward	Enables access to information that would otherwise be unavailable (due to the employee being inaccessible directly, for instance in positions where employees are at sea for prolonged periods).	Risks employee spending time describing irrelevant aspects of the work Greater potential need for follow ups to clarify new information Longest delays to achieve outcomes No real control on when the information may be sent back to the advisor. This could generate additional delays in some instances.
Combination	Combining discussion and questionnaire Where information needed would be difficult to obtain via questionnaire Where additional details could be answered with follow up questions	Most flexible: access to employee and follow up questions when needed	Employee availability for interviews Risks of receiving irrelevant information Longer delays to achieve outcomes

Figure 12. Job Validation Review methodology options

10.4.2 Engage

Employees can find a JVR to be stressful; preparing them is important, and should include:

- **Explain the purpose of the review**, what to expect, each person's role, and answer their questions regarding the process to allay their concerns.
- **Ask** the employee to be prepared to share examples of work related to the content of their JD.
- **Schedule the review.** Share a list of broad topics that will be explored, such as key activities, latitude for decision making, supervisory/leadership functions, who they are in contact with, etc.

- **Share documents:** These include the JD and organizational chart (both approved by the manager beforehand) to ensure all are working from the same documents.

10.4.3 Discover

Conducting the JVR:

- **No interruptions:** If meeting with the employee, ensure there will be no interruptions.
- Ask open-ended questions, without bias.
- **Establish the primary purpose of the work**, and how it fits into the organization.
- **If duties have been added or have changed over time:**
 - Explore what aspects of the work changed, with concrete examples and the dates when those changes occurred.
 - The dates when duties changed are of particular importance when a retroactive effective date is considered for the classification decision, and in the context of a potential reclassification.
- **Inform the employee of next steps.** Allow the employee (within a specified period) to provide further information.
- General considerations if meeting directly with the employee:
 - Take copious notes; don't rely on memory to write the report.
 - If possible, visit the work site to obtain a thorough understanding of the work, particularly for technical and physically demanding jobs; this provides a perspective that is difficult to replicate in other ways.
- Avoid:
 - **committing to any particular outcome** from the JVR.
 - **referring to examples of work as "evidence," or "proof"** of the duties performed; this is a discovery exercise, not a criminal investigation.

10.4.4 Draft

The Job Validation Report presents the results of the JVR, informs, and supports the classification evaluation of the job. The report should contain the strongest job facts provided and reflect the complexity of the work.

Author of the Report

The OC advisor is responsible for the development of the Job Validation Report and its content. Authors must balance the value of ensuring that the employee's concerns are included with the requirement for succinctness. The employee and subsequently the manager are provided an opportunity to comment on the draft report, and the final report is shared with them when complete. It is only the OC advisor that signs and dates the report.

Best Practice: Write the JVR immediately after the information has been gathered to avoid the omission of important details. If multiple JVRs are being conducted over a short period of time, the OC advisor should plan the sessions or visits to align with enough time to ensure the development of the report for each of them.

Format of the Report

Job validation reports should be organized in a way to best convey the information they contain. While some are organized by Key Activity, the information may be presented in the way that best suits the case. The job's organizational context should be clear, including its interactions with others. JVRs should include:

- **Position information:** Position number, Job number, job title, location, current group/level, incumbent name, Supervisor's title, group/level, and position number), the proposed effective date of the JD implementation, and the date and location of the JVR.

- **Background:** A brief history of the job/position, organizational context, request background, and timelines associate with the case. This section presents this information as it is known when the JVR is conducted; additional information may come to light during or after the JVR, which will be included in the job evaluation documentation.
- **Purpose of the JVR:** Why the JVR is being conducted.
- **Methodology:** Explain how the JVR was conducted, and details if one or more focus group(s) was/were convened.
- **Evolution of Work:** Explain what changes have occurred (if any); for example, when and why of changes to: mandate or program, division, management layer, activities added/removed, etc.
- **Proposed Effective Date:** Managers are responsible for establishing a reasonable and evidence based effective date. Include any advice prod to management regarding the effective date. The dates associated with the incumbent performing the duties described in the JD will inform the determination of the most appropriate effective date as a result, this proposed date may differ from the final effective date of the job.
- **Job facts supported by concrete examples:** Include work examples demonstrating the greatest variety and highest complexity of duties, as well as those most relevant to the purpose of the JVR. Examples of work should be described in the report; addendums of work examples should not be added ***unless they cannot otherwise be described.***
- **Conclusions and recommendations:** Provide an overall analysis and reasoning supporting coincidence or non-coincidence between duties assigned and performed and the JD.

10.4.5 Consult

Both the employee and the manager should be given the opportunity to comment on the contents of the report, and the report should indicate that this has been done, even if they have no comments to add.

Employee consultation: The employee is provided an opportunity to comment on the draft report to ensure the most accurate possible portrayal of the job, allowing for the correction of any information that may have been misunderstood. Additional comments could be included separately in the report, as appropriate. The OC advisor has the authority to decide what comments will be incorporated into the report.

Manager consultation: After the employee's comments relevant to the case have been captured, the manager is also provided an opportunity to comment on the report. Additional comments could be included separately in the report. As managers are uniquely responsible for assigning work to their employees and organizing the work of their teams, they are consulted to ensure that the work described in the JVR has been assigned, and that assigned duties are included in the JD.

10.4.6 Finalize the JVR

After the employee and manager have been consulted, the conclusion(s) of the review, as supported by the contents of the interview and consultations, are added to the report.

Conclusions and Recommendations:

- **Validation of appropriate JD:** the OC advisor's conclusions and recommendations regarding JD content, its applicability to the position, and alternative options are included in the report. This can also include selecting a better fit JD and proposing it to the Manager.
- **Information pertaining to effective dates:** If pertinent information is discovered during the JVR, it must be included in the report with evidence-based recommendations to the manager, who is delegated to decide the effective date of the JD.

Coincidence:

The report's narrative must contain conclusions based on whether and how the duties assigned to, and carried out by, the employee coincide – or not – with those described in the JD. It is not sufficient to simply indicate, "coincidence or non-coincidence." The Report should include a concise summary explaining the main points of coincidence (referring to specific examples of work), or an analysis of relevant concerns in the case of non-coincidence.

When **Non-Coincidence** is found between the work described in the JD and the work performed by the employee, the OC advisor informs the manager and advises on next steps).

- In most cases, the evaluation of the job cannot proceed until the non-coincidence situation is resolved, either by the application of an accurate JD, or adding or removing employee responsibilities.

Examples of circumstances in which duties are non-coincident:

- The employee is performing duties which the manager did not assign to them and are not included in the JD.
 - If the manager was aware that the additional duties were being performed and did not request that their employee stop doing them, the duties must be included in the JD applied to the position and evaluated with a retroactive effective date commensurate with the date on which the incumbent began to perform those duties.
 - If the manager was aware that the duties were being performed and had instructed that they stop doing them, the duties must be included in the JD, but only up until the date on which the manager instructed them to stop. This may result in two different JDs being applied for two different time periods.
- The employee not performing all duties that are described in the JD:
 - If the manager was aware that not all the duties were being performed and did not request that they be performed:
 - the duties must not be reflected in the JD applied to the position (another JD must be applied); or
 - the duties must be immediately assigned and evidenced for the duties to be part of the work moving forward, with a re-assessment of the effective date.
 - If the manager was not aware of this, the manager is required to discuss the situation with the employee, and further investigation is likely required.
- The employee stating that they are asked to perform key activities which are not included in their JDs. This will require potentially applying a different JD to the position, provided that there is evidence demonstrating that the duties are being assigned by management. The manager should be consulted to confirm the duties in question. There are, however, circumstances in which non-coincidence is not only predictable, but acceptable, and does not impede the evaluation process. An example of this is a situation in which an organizational design project has been conducted with the update of multiple JDs, and a reclassification is foreseen/expected, but the new duties will not be assigned until the effective date of the application of the new decision to that incumbent's position. The incumbent is not yet performing all the duties described in the new JD, so non-coincidence would be expected in those specific areas, and the OC advisor could move on with the next step of the evaluation process. The JVR should explain why there is non-coincidence, and why it is appropriate that the duties remain in the JD. Other situations where an employee is not performing all assigned activities, but in which it is appropriate that the non-coincident duties remain in the JD are:
 - The employee is being performance managed, but the duties ARE required.
 - The employee just started in the position and is in the process of being trained to perform some of the duties.

Any additional issues or concerns

Before finalizing the report by signing it, the OC advisor must ensure that any and all issues the JVR has revealed have been included.

Reviewer's name and date.

As the party responsible for the development of the JVR report, the last step in the JVR process is the OC advisor adding their signature and date.

ANNEX A - Setting the stage when Beginning the JVR Process

Some employees are anxious when taking part in JVRs. Sharing the following information with them can help to set the stage for the information gathering exercise, as appropriate.

Job validation reviews are simply information gathering exercises conducted with you, the employee, to get a better understanding of the day-to-day duties of the job. As the employee performing those duties, you are uniquely qualified to describe your work. It is important to note that the Job Validation Review is not assessing your work performance. It is an opportunity for you, considered the expert in doing your job, to explain the details of your position's duties and work activities so that the full scope and complexity of your work are clear.

The information you provide will be documented in a Job Validation Report. Once drafted, this report will be shared with you for your comments. This will be your opportunity to ensure that the examples of work are accurately represented in the report, and that no facts have been misunderstood. When reviewing the draft report, you may find that some examples of work that you provided during the Job Validation Review are not included in the report. My role is to ensure that the full scope and complexity of your work is considered when the work is being evaluated; to do this, the report will include the strongest work examples that you share.

After you have provided your comments on the report, your supervisor/manager will also have an opportunity to comment on its contents before it is finalized.